55 **'In early life he observed many austerities':** Abd al-Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 3, translated and edited by Sir Wolseley Haig, Calcutta: Asiatic Society of Bengal, 1925, Delhi: Idarah-i-Adabiyat-I (repr.), 2009, p. 118.

55 **'gave everyone who came to the threshold…hopes of rank and jagir':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 2, p. 151.

56 **'for this noble work, wisdom and courage was necessary':** Ibid.

56 **A time will come on men, when none will become favourites:** Badauni quoted in Afshan Majid, 'Women and a Theologian: The Ideas and Narratives of Abdul Qadir Badauni', *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 71, 2010–11, p. 249.

57 **Maham Anaga claimed for herself an ancient role:** For a discussion on performance of piety by Muslim women, see Gavin Hambly, *Women in the Medieval Islamic World: Power, Patronage, and Piety*, New York: St. Martin's Press, 1998. To see the role of Shah Jahan's wives and daughters in the building of mosques in Shahjahanabad, see Mukhoty, *Daughters of the Sun*.

57 **surprising that so much of it remains shrouded in mystery:** For different interpretation by scholars, see Swapna Liddle, *Delhi: 14 Historical Walks*, New Delhi: Westland, 2011; Monica Juneja, *Architecture in Medieval India: Forms, Contexts, Histories*, New Delhi: Permanent Black, 2001.

58 **a fiercely independent woman who did not hesitate to speak her mind:** See Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*.

58 **'in spite of the ties of love between her and H. M. [Akbar]':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 3, p. 107.

59 **'one of his wives had loved [Humayun] so faithfully':** J. S. Hoyland (trans.), *The Commentary of Father Monserrate, S. J. on His Journey to the Court of Akbar*, New Delhi: Asian Education Services, 2003, p. 96.

PART 2: THE YOUNG PADSHAH (1561–1569)

63 **'enter the harem and after his meal':** Leslie M. Crump, *The Lady of the Lotus: Rup Mati, Queen of Māndu: A Strange Tale of Forgiveness*, Milford: Oxford University Press, 1926, p. 49.

63 **'advised her lover to sacrifice pleasure':** Crump, *Lady of the Lotus*, p. 48.

63 **'unlawful and vicious practices':** Satish Chandra, *Medieval India: From Sultanat to the Mughals, 1526–1748*, Part 2, New Delhi: Har-Anand Publications, 1999, 2006 (repr.), p. 103.

63 **'to spread justice and be balm for the wounds of the oppressed':** Ibid., p. 191.

63 **'tyranny and injustice Baz Bahadur had wrought upon the people of Malwa':** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 411.

64 **'had the captives brought before them':** Abd al-Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, translated and edited by W. H. Lowe, Calcutta: Asiatic Society of Bengal, 1884, p. 47.

64 **'put them all to death and burnt them':** Ibid., p. 48.

64 **'in one single night all these captives have been taken':** Ibid., p. 47.

64 **'began to indulge in pleasure':** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 423.

65 **'everything he had taken from Baz Bahadur's estate':** Ibid., p. 437.

65 **mother's servants to bring away two 'rare beauties':** Ibid., p. 439.

66 **'they are dirty and do not know the civilized ways':** Ibn Battuta, *The Travels of Ibn Battuta, A.D. 1325–1354*, Vol. 3, edited by H. A. R. Gibb, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1971, 2017 (repr.), p. 741.

66 **women slaves in the households of noblemen were called paristaran:** Shadab Bano, 'Women Slaves in Medieval India', *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 65,